

DAY 11 / 30

THE FORGE · PRACTICAL GENAI

Your first great prompt: anatomy of a good instruction

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"Write me a marketing email" and "Write a 150-word marketing email for busy IT managers, announcing our new uptime SLA, in a confident but not salesy tone, with a single clear call to action" will get you two completely different quality levels of output. Same model. Same person. Wildly different results.

- ◆ Task — what exactly do you want done? Be specific about the verb: summarize, compare, rewrite, critique.
- ◆ Context — what does the model need to know that it can't guess? Your audience, your constraints, relevant background.
- ◆ Format — how should the output look? Length, structure, tone, bullet points vs prose.
- ◆ Examples (when it matters) — showing one sample of what "good" looks like often outperforms paragraphs of description. More on this tomorrow.

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“What's the vaguest prompt that surprised you by working well anyway?”

Follow along – Day 12 drops tomorrow.

#PromptEngineering

#AI

#GenerativeAI

#Productivity